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CASE 3 · CA DESIGN LAB

VIVA

Talking to a bus without a driver

△ CASE

When there is no driver, who reassures, informs and helps the passengers?

In an autonomous bus the driver is gone, but the driver did much more than drive: operator, security person, information point and help on board. Without a driver, passengers have no one to ask about a detour, when they feel unsure, or after an accident. The VIVA project (Virtual In-Vehicle Assistant) asks what could fill this gap, and what should stay with humans.

PRACTICE

- No operator runs a VIVA-like assistant yet; pilot projects exist for autonomous vehicles in general.
- On board there is no contact person and no link to the operator.

RESEARCH

- Design principles (Staritz et al., 2025) and design features (Fröhlich et al., 2026) for VIVA.
- Open tension: where must a human, for example in a control centre, stay in the loop?

USERS

- Everyone who boards and might have a question or need help.
- Talk to diverse people: women and men, older and younger, not only students.

OPEN QUESTIONS

01 What do passengers lose when the driver is gone?

02 Which of the driver's tasks should an agent never take over?

WHAT YOU GET

- Two core papers on design principles and design features
- The video of the earlier prototype, after you choose the case
- Access to the campus experiment
- Further literature from Amilia



YOUR SUPERVISOR

Amilia Fröhlich